

Kinetic art

Between 1913 and 1920, artists including Gabo, Duchamp and Tatlin began to emphasize mechanical movement in some of their work. Duchamp's *Bicycle Wheel* of 1913, the first of his readymades, comprises a stool with a freely spinning bicycle wheel fixed into it. In 1920, Alexander Rodchenko also created moving art, with hanging mobiles of geometric shapes – Constructivist objects that he called *spatial constructions*. Also in 1920, the word 'kinetic' was first used to describe moving art by Gabo and his sculptor brother Antoine Pevsner (1886–1962) in their *Realistic Manifesto*. The idea flourished into a lively trend with an exhibition, 'Le Mouvement', in Paris in 1955.

Kinetic artists were fascinated by the possibilities of movement in art, and its potential to create new, interactive experiences among viewers. Jean Tinguely (1925–91) created large-scale works welded out of scrap metal, while Alexander Calder (1898–1976) built mobiles with delicately balanced or suspended components that move in response to motor power or air currents.



Tinguely, *Metamatic No. 1*, 1959